



CS61C

Great Ideas
in
Computer Architecture
(a.k.a. Machine Structures)

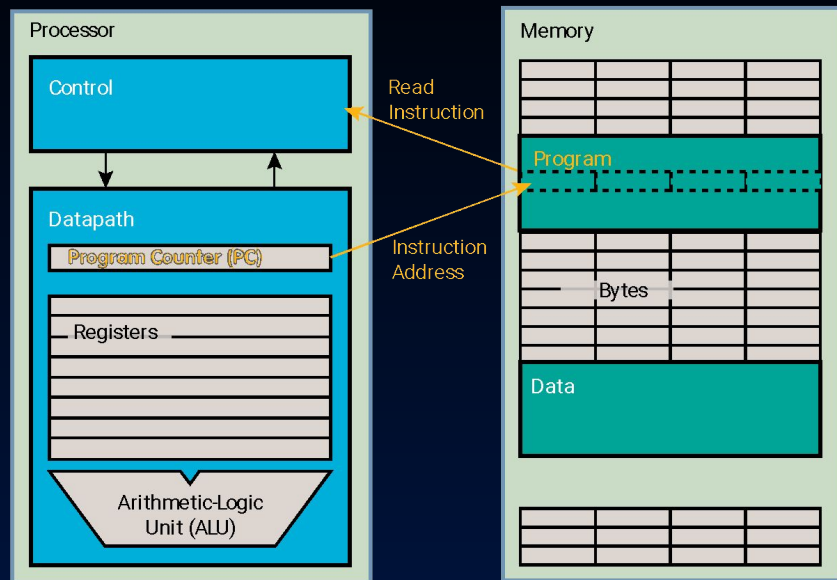


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RISC-V Procedures



Review: RISC-V Control Flow



Instruction	Name/description
<code>beq rs1 rs2 Label</code>	Branch if Equal
<code>bne rs1 rs2 Label</code>	Branch if Not Equal
<code>blt rs1 rs2 Label</code>	Branch if Less Than (signed) ($rs1 < rs2$)
<code>bge rs1 rs2 Label</code>	Branch if Greater or Equal (signed) ($rs1 \geq rs2$)
<code>bltu rs1 rs2 Label</code>	Branch if Less Than (unsigned)
<code>bgeu rs1 rs2 Label</code>	Branch if Greater Than or Equal (unsigned)
<code>j Label</code>	Unconditional jump



Function Calls

- Function Calls
- Stack Frames
- RISC-V Calling Convention
- [Venus] Recursive Example
- [Reference] Summary, Other Registers
- [Extra] Recursive Example 2

jal: Call a Function, jr: Return from a Function

- **J**ump **a**nd **l**ink

```
jal rd Label
```

```
R[rd] = PC + 4
```

```
PC = <address of Label>
```

Really should be:
"Link and Jump"!

- **J**ump **r**egister (pseudo)

```
jr rs1
```

```
PC = R[rs1]
```

Common instruction pair:

- jal ra FunctionName
- jr ra

ra (**return address**) is a register name for register x1.



jal, jr in action

0x 0	main:
	li a0 4
4	jal ra factorial
8	addi a1 a0 0
...	...
20	li a0 3
24	jal ra factorial
28	addi a1 a0 0
...	...
48	factorial:
	addi t0 x0 1
4c	addi t1 x0 1
50	loop:
	blt a0 t0 done
54	mul t1 t1 t0
58	addi t0 t0 1
5c	j loop
60	done:
	add a0 t1 x0
64	jr ra

Function call:

jal @ 0x4

pc

0x4

0x48

ra

~~0xABCD~~ ABCD

0x8

Function return:

jr @ 0x64

pc

~~0x64~~

0x8

ra

0x8



jal, jr in action

```
0x 0  main:
      4      li a0 4
      8      jal ra factorial
      8      addi a1 a0 0
      ...
     20      ...
     20      li a0 3
     24      jal ra factorial
     28      addi a1 a0 0
     ...
    48  factorial:
        addi t0 x0 1
    4c    addi t1 x0 1
    50  loop:
        blt a0 t0 done
    54    mul t1 t1 t0
    58    addi t0 t0 1
    5c    j loop
    60  done:
        add a0 t1 x0
     64      jr ra
```



Function call:
jal @ 0x24

Function return:
jr @ 0x64

pc	0x24	0x48
ra	0xA	0x28
pc	0x64	0x28
ra	0x28	

Four common jump instructions/pseudoinstructions

- | | |
|--|---|
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"> • Jump and link <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <code>jal rd Label</code> $R[rd] = PC + 4$ $PC = \text{<address of Label>}$ | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> • Jump register (pseudo) <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <code>jr rs1</code> $PC = R[rs1]$ ◦ Translation: <code>jalr x0 rs1 0</code> |
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"> • Jump and link register <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <code>jalr rd rs1 imm</code> $R[rd] = PC + 4$ $PC = R[rs1] + \text{imm}$ | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> • Jump (pseudo) <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <code>j Label</code> $PC = \text{<address of Label>}$ ◦ Translation: <code>jal x0 Label</code> |



Four common jump instructions/pseudoinstructions

- **J**ump **a**nd **l**ink
`jal rd Label`
- **J**ump **r**egister (pseudo)
`jr rs1`
 - Translation: `jalr x0 rs1 0`
- **J**ump **a**nd **l**ink **r**egister
`jalr rd rs1 imm`
- **J**ump (pseudo)
`j Label`
 - Translation: `jal x0 Label`

Read more in
course notes



RISC-V Register Conventions, Part 1 of 3

- Registers faster than memory, so use them!
 - Register names provide **conventions** for calling functions, passing in arguments, and returning from functions.
- a0–a7 (x10–x17):
 - eight argument registers to pass parameters
 - two return values (a0–a1), though we usually use a0
- ra (x1):
 - one return address register to return to the point of origin
- More later: stack pointer, saved registers, temporary registers

Different functions share the **same set of registers** and use them with the **same calling conventions**.



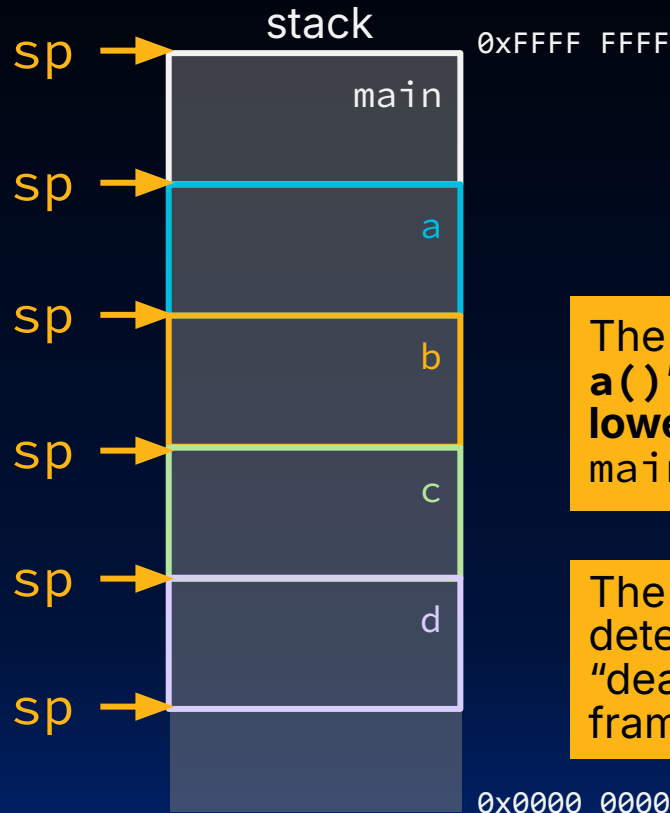
Stack Frames

- Function Calls
- Stack Frames
- RISC-V Calling Convention
- [Venus] Recursive Example
- [Reference] Summary, Other Registers
- [Extra] Recursive Example 2



[Review] C Stack Frames

```
int main ()
{ a(0); ...
}
void a (int m)
{ b(1);
}
void b (int n)
{ c(2);
}
void c (int o)
{ d(3);
}
void d (int p)
{
}
```



The stack **grows downward**; **a()**'s local variables have **lower byte addresses** than **main()**'s, and so on.

The **stack pointer** (`sp`) is what determines "allocating" and "deallocating/freeing" stack frames!

[animate this slide]



RISC-V Stack

- RISC-V stack frames (mostly) operate like C stack frames.
 - Stack pointer register: `sp (x2)`
 - A function can choose to use a stack frame by manipulating `sp`:
 - After a function is called, **create** stack frame/**decrement** `sp`.
 - When function wraps up, **delete** stack frame/**increment** `sp`.
- Stack frame can include:
 - Space for local variables (e.g., stack arrays)
 - Return "instruction" address (why?)
 - Parameters (arguments) beyond the 8 argument registers

Not all RISC-V functions need stack frames. Some functions only need registers! (see earlier example)



Fundamental Steps in Calling a Function

1. Set up arguments Put arguments in `a0, ..., a7`, etc.
2. Transfer control to function `jal ra fnLabel`
3. Prologue Acquire (local) storage resources needed for function: stack, registers
4. Perform desired function task
5. Epilogue
 - Put return value `a0` (or `a1`)
 - Restore any registers used
 - Release local storage on stack
6. Return control to point of origin `jr ra`



The RISC-V Stack Also Grows Down

0x 0

4

...

...

20

24

28

...

50

54

...

70

...

main:

addi sp sp -12

...

x calls fooA

...

addi sp sp 12

j exit

fooA:

addi sp sp -8

...

addi sp sp 8

jr ra

...

exit:

...

+3

+2

+1

+0

0xFFFF FFD4

0xFFFF FFD8

0xFFFF FFD4

0xFFFF FFD0

0xFFFF FFCC

0xFFFF FFC8

0xFFFF FFC4

0xFFFF FF

"main's" stack frame

0xB0BA CAFE

0xABCD EF12

0x3456 7890

0xB0BA CAFE

0xABCD EF12

sp 0xFFFF FFD4

"main's" stack pointer

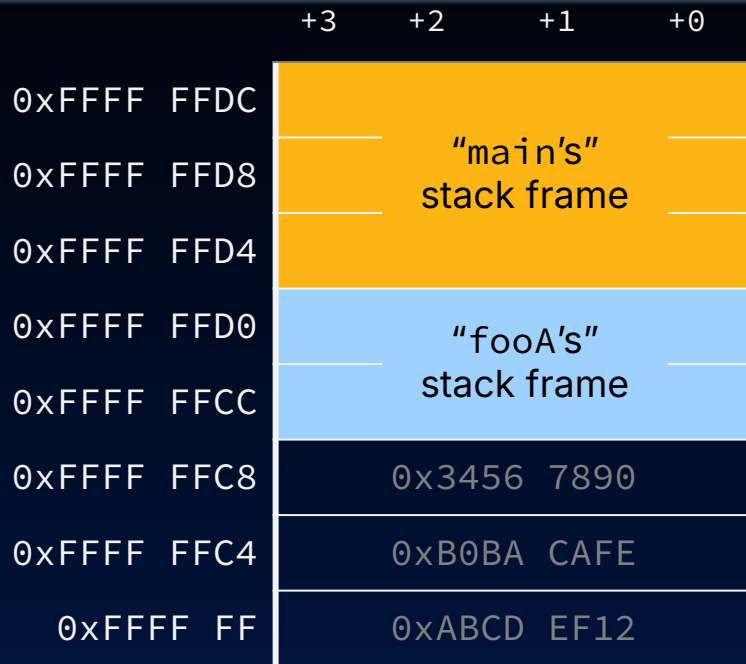




The RISC-V Stack Also Grows Down

```
0x 0  main:
    4      addi sp sp -12
    ...
    ...    # x calls fooA
    ...
   20      addi sp sp 12
   24      j  exit

   28  fooA:
    ...    addi sp sp -8
    ...
   50      addi sp sp 8
   54      jr  ra
    ...
   70  exit:
    ...
```



sp 0xFFFF FFCC

"fooA's" stack pointer



The RISC-V Stack Also Grows Down

0x 0

4

...

...

20

24

28

...

50

54

...

70

...

main:

addi sp sp -12

...

x calls fooA

...

addi sp sp 12

j exit

fooA:

addi sp sp -8

...

addi sp sp 8

jr ra

...

exit:

...

+3

+2

+1

+0

0xFFFF FFD4

0xFFFF FFD8

0xFFFF FFD4

0xFFFF FFD0

0xFFFF FFCC

0xFFFF FFC8

0xFFFF FFC4

0xFFFF FF

"main's" stack frame

"fooA's" stack frame

0x3456 7890

0xB0BA CAFE

0xABCD EF12

Restore caller's (here, main's) stack pointer before "returning"

sp → 0xFFFF FFD4





The RISC-V Stack Also Grows Down

```
0x 0  main:
    4      addi sp sp -12
    ...
    ...    # x calls fooA
    ...
    20     addi sp sp 12
    24     j  exit

    28  fooA:
    ...    addi sp sp -8
    ...
    50     addi sp sp 8
    54     jr  ra
    ...
    70  exit:
    ...
```

	+3	+2	+1	+0
0xFFFF FFD4	"main's" stack frame			
0xFFFF FFD8				
0xFFFF FFD0				
0xFFFF FFD0	0x0000 0001			
0xFFFF FFCC	0x0000 FACE			
0xFFFF FFC8	0x3456 7890			
0xFFFF FFC4	0xB0BA CAFE			
0xFFFF FF	0xABCD EF12			

sp 0xFFFF FFD4

When main "has control," it sees
the right stack pointer

RISC-V Register Conventions, Part 2 of 3

- Registers faster than memory, so use them!
 - Use stack frames sparingly!
- a0–a7 (x10–x17):
 - eight argument registers to pass parameters
 - two return values (a0–a1), though we usually use a0
- ra (x1):
 - one return address register to return to the point of origin
- sp (x2):
 - stack pointer has address of bottom of stack (current stack frame)

Different functions share the **same set of registers** and use them with the **same calling conventions**.

new ↻

RISC-V Register Conventions, Part 3 of 3

- Registers faster than memory, so use them!
 - Use stack frames sparingly!
 - a0–a7 (x10–x17):
 - eight argument registers to pass parameters
 - two return values (a0–a1), though we usually use a0
 - ra (x1):
 - one return address register to return to the point of origin
 - sp (x2):
 - stack pointer has address of bottom of stack (current stack frame)
 - s0–s11 (x8, x9, x18–x27): Saved registers
 - t0–t6 (x5–x7, x28–x31): Temporary registers
- } ?????

Different functions share the **same set of registers** and use them with the **same calling conventions**.



RISC-V Calling Convention

- Function Calls
- Stack Frames
- RISC-V Calling Convention
- [Venus] Recursive Example
- [Reference] Summary, Other Registers
- [Extra] Recursive Example 2

✗ Clobbered Registers with Nested Function Calls

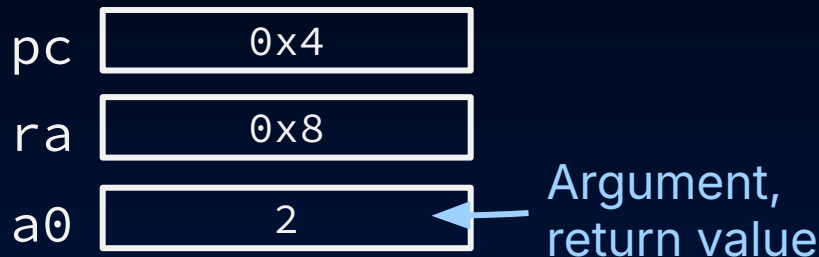
- Suppose we implement a **recursive** factorial function.

Below, what is the issue with `factorial(2)`?

Caller `factorial(2)`'s perspective:

1. Prepare for **callee** `factorial(1)` by passing in new argument, 1
2. Pass control to **callee** `factorial(1)`
3. Multiply **callee**'s return value by multiplying by original argument, 2
4. Return result

```
// assume non-negative numbers
int factorial(int n) {
    if (n == 1) return 1;
    int a = n*factorial(n-1);
    return a;
}
```



Because all functions use the same RISC-V **calling convention**, register values can get **clobbered** with nested function calls.



Register Calling Conventions

- **Caller**: the calling function
- **Callee**: the function being called
- When **callee** returns from executing, the **caller** needs to know:
 - Which registers may have changed, and
 - Which are guaranteed to be unchanged.
- Register **calling conventions**: A set of generally accepted rules as to which registers will be unchanged after a procedure call (jal) and which may be changed.
- To reduce expensive loads and stores from spilling and restoring registers, RISC-V function-calling convention divides registers into two categories:
 - **Not** preserved across function call
 - **Are** preserved across function call (if the **callee** changed any registers, it restored original values before returning)

Caller-saved vs. Callee-saved registers

- **Caller**-saved: *(if data in them)*
 - Return address, ra
 - Temporary registers, t0–t6
 - Arguments/retvals, a0–a7
 - May **not** be preserved across function call!
 - **Caller** is responsible for
 - Saving these register values **for itself before calling a callee**
- **Callee**-saved: *(if it uses them)*
 - Stack pointer, sp
 - Saved registers, s0–s11
 - Should be preserved across function call!
 - **Callee** is responsible for
 - Saving/restoring these registers values in the **function prologue**, and **epilogue**, respectively
 - Allocating/deallocating the **stack frame**.

Caller: To save register values, save to s0–s11 or to your stack frame.

Callee: To save register values, make space in your stack frame.

Fundamental Steps in Calling a Function: CALLER

1. Set up for callee
 2. Transfer control to callee
 3. Prologue
 4. Perform desired function task
 5. Epilogue
 6. Return control to point of origin
- { Save caller-saved registers **if needed**,
 either by copying to s0-s11 or to stack
 Put arguments in a0, ..., a7, stack, etc.
`jal ra fnLabel`
- { `jr ra # callee`
 Restore caller-saved registers if needed

Fundamental Steps in Calling a Function: CALLEE

1. Set up for callee
2. Transfer control to callee
3. Prologue
 - Push stack frame/decrement `sp`
 - Save callee-saved regs if will use:
 - `s0-s11`
 - Save `ra` if calling subroutine
 - Save place for local non-register variables (e.g., stack arrays)
4. Perform desired function task
5. Epilogue
 - Put return value `a0` (and `a1` if nec)
 - Restore any callee-saved registers used, restore `ra` if called subroutine
 - Pop stack frame/increment `sp`
6. Return control to point of origin
 - `jr ra # callee`
 - Restore caller-saved registers if needed



[Venus] Recursive Example

- Function Calls
- Stack Frames
- RISC-V Calling Convention
- [Venus] Recursive Example
- [Reference] Summary, Other Registers
- [Extra] Recursive Example 2

(1/7) Recursive Factorial

```

0x 0  main:
      li a0 3
4     jal ra factorial
      ...
48    factorial:
      addi sp sp -8    } Prologue
4c    sw ra 0(sp)
50    sw s0 4(sp)
54    mv s0 a0
58    li t0 1
5c    bne s0 t0 recurse
60    li a0 1
64    j epilogue
68    recurse:
      addi a0 s0 -1
6c    jal ra factorial
70    mul a0 s0 a0
74    epilogue:
      lw ra 0(sp)      } Epilogue
78    lw s0 4(sp)
7c    addi sp sp 8
80    jr ra

```

1. Prologue:
 - a. How large is the stack frame?
 - b. Which registers get saved to the stack?
2. 0x6c: As caller, what do we save before making the recursive call? Why?
3. Why do we use the temporary register t0?
4. Epilogue: Do we restore registers first or pop stack frame?
5. 0x64: Why j epilogue? Why not j ra?



(2/7) Recursive Factorial: C Code

```

0x 0  main:
      li a0 3
4     jal ra factorial
...
48    factorial:
      addi sp sp -8    } Prologue
4c    sw ra 0(sp)
50    sw s0 4(sp)
54    mv s0 a0
58    li t0 1
5c    bne s0 t0 recurse
60    li a0 1
64    j epilogue
68    recurse:
      addi a0 s0 -1
6c    jal ra factorial
70    mul a0 s0 a0
74    epilogue:
      lw ra 0(sp)      } Epilogue
78    lw s0 4(sp)
7c    addi sp sp 8
80    jr ra

```

Set breakpoints:

- factorial(4): 0x4
- factorial(3): 0x24
- factorial: 0x48
 - Base case: 0x64
 - Recursive call: 0x6c

Check: registers a0, s0

```

// assume non-negative numbers
int factorial(int n) {
    if (n == 1) return 1;
    int a = n*factorial(n-1);
    return a;
}

```

(3/7) Recursive Factorial: Question 1

```

0x 0  main:
      li a0 3
      jal ra factorial
4
...
48 factorial:
      addi sp sp -8
4c      sw ra 0(sp)
50      sw s0 4(sp)
54      mv s0 a0
58      li t0 1
5c      bne s0 t0 recurse
60      li a0 1
64      j epilogue
68 recurse:
      addi a0 s0 -1
6c      jal ra factorial
70      mul a0 s0 a0
74 epilogue:
      lw ra 0(sp)
78      lw s0 4(sp)
7c      addi sp sp 8
80      jr ra

```

Prologue

Epilogue

1. Prologue:
 - a. How large is the stack frame?
 - 8B
 - b. Which registers get saved to the stack?
 - Our ra, because we (may) do a recursive function call
 - Our caller's s0

```

// assume non-negative numbers
int factorial(int n) {
    if (n == 1) return 1;
    int a = n*factorial(n-1);
    return a;
}

```

(4/7) Recursive Factorial: Question 2

```

0x 0  main:
      li a0 3
      jal ra factorial
      ...
48 factorial:
      addi sp sp -8
      sw ra 0(sp)
      sw s0 4(sp)
      mv s0 a0
      li t0 1
      bne s0 t0 recurse
      li a0 1
      j epilogue
68 recurse:
      addi a0 s0 -1
      jal ra factorial
      mul a0 s0 a0
74 epilogue:
      lw ra 0(sp)
      lw s0 4(sp)
      addi sp sp 8
      jr ra

```

Prologue

Epilogue

2. 0x6c: As caller, what do we save before making the recursive call? Why?

- Copy argument a0 to saved register s0
- Need to use s0 after recursive call completes

```

// assume non-negative numbers
int factorial(int n) {
    if (n == 1) return 1;
    int a = n*factorial(n-1);
    return a;
}

```

(5/7) Recursive Factorial: Question 3

```

0x 0  main:
      li a0 3
      jal ra factorial
      ...
48 factorial:
      addi sp sp -8
      sw ra 0(sp)
      sw s0 4(sp)
      mv s0 a0
      li t0 1
      bne s0 t0 recurse
      li a0 1
      j epilogue
68 recurse:
      addi a0 s0 -1
      jal ra factorial
      mul a0 s0 a0
74 epilogue:
      lw ra 0(sp)
      lw s0 4(sp)
      addi sp sp 8
      jr ra

```

Prologue

Epilogue

3. Why do we use the temporary register t0?

- Base case is 1
- Branch instruction compares two registers

```

// assume non-negative numbers
int factorial(int n) {
    if (n == 1) return 1;
    int a = n*factorial(n-1);
    return a;
}

```

(6/7) Recursive Factorial: Question 4

```

0x 0  main:
      li a0 3
      jal ra factorial
4
...
48 factorial:
      addi sp sp -8
4c      sw ra 0(sp)
50      sw s0 4(sp)
54      mv s0 a0
58      li t0 1
5c      bne s0 t0 recurse
60      li a0 1
64      j epilogue
68 recurse:
      addi a0 s0 -1
6c      jal ra factorial
70      mul a0 s0 a0
74 epilogue:
78      lw ra 0(sp)
7c      lw s0 4(sp)
80      addi sp sp 8
      jr ra

```

} Prologue

} Epilogue

4. Epilogue: Do we restore registers first or pop stack frame?

- Pop stack frame at the very end, right before returning

```

// assume non-negative numbers
int factorial(int n) {
    if (n == 1) return 1;
    int a = n*factorial(n-1);
    return a;
}

```



```

0x 0  main:
      li a0 3
      jal ra factorial
      ...
48    factorial:
      addi sp sp -8
4c    sw ra 0(sp)
50    sw s0 4(sp)
54    mv s0 a0
58    li t0 1
5c    bne s0 t0 recurse
60    li a0 1
64    j epilogue
68    recurse:
      addi a0 s0 -1
6c    jal ra factorial
70    mul a0 s0 a0
74    epilogue:
      lw ra 0(sp)
78    lw s0 4(sp)
7c    addi sp sp 8
80    jr ra

```

Prologue

Epilogue

5. 0x64: Why **j epilogue**?

Why not **j ra**?

- When returning, **we are always responsible for deallocating our own stack frame!**
- We must also restore registers:
 - Restore **our ra**, since it may have changed if we made a recursive fn call
 - Restore **our caller's s0**, so they can use it

```

// assume non-negative numbers
int factorial(int n) {
    if (n == 1) return 1;
    int a = n*factorial(n-1);
    return a;
}

```



Agenda

[Reference] Summary, Other Registers

- Function Calls
- Stack Frames
- RISC-V Calling Convention
- [Venus] Recursive Example
- [Reference] Summary, Other Registers
- [Extra] Recursive Example 2



[Summary] RISC-V So Far

- Arithmetic
 - add
 - sub
 - and
 - or
 - xor
 - sll
 - srl
 - sra
- Immediate
 - addi
 - andi
 - ori
 - xori
 - slli
 - srli
 - srai
 - li (pseudo)
- Loads/Stores
 - lw
 - lb
 - lbu
 - sw
 - sb
- Branches/Jumps
 - beq
 - bne
 - bge
 - blt
 - bgeu
 - bltu
 - j (pseudo)
 - jalr
 - jal
 - jr (pseudo)



Summary: RISC-V Calling Convention

- Registers faster than memory, so use them!
 - Use stack frames sparingly!
- a0–a7 (x10–x17):
 - eight argument registers to pass parameters
 - two return values (a0–a1), though we usually use a0Caller-saved
- ra (x1):
 - one return address register to return to the point of originCaller-saved
- sp (x2):
 - stack pointer has address of bottom of stack (current stack frame)Callee-saved
- s0–s11 (x8, x9, x18–x27): Saved registersCallee-saved
- t0–t6 (x5–x7, x28–x31): Temporary registersCaller-saved

Different functions share the **same set of registers** and use them with the **same calling conventions**.



Other Registers

These registers that are out of scope for this class (don't use them!)

- gp: The x3 register, used to store a reference to the heap. Also called the "global pointer"
- tp: The x4 register, used to store separate stacks for threads
 - (multithreading covered way later)



Agenda

[Extra] Recursive Example 2

- Function Calls
- Stack Frames
- RISC-V Calling Convention
- [Venus] Recursive Example
- [Reference] Summary, Other Registers
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C code

```
int foo(int i) {  
    if (i == 0) return 0;  
    int a = i + foo(i-1);  
    return a;  
}  
int j = foo(3);  
int k = foo(100);  
int m = j+k;
```



RISC-V code

```
j main
foo:      # int foo(int i)
addi sp sp -8 # Prologue
sw ra 0(sp) # Prologue
sw s0 4(sp)  # Prologue
mv s0 a0     # Move i
bne s0 x0 Next# if i != 0, skip
this
li a0 0      # int a = 0;
j Epilogue   # Go to Epilogue
            # (to restore stack)
```

Next:

```
addi a0 s0 -1 # int j = i - 1;
jal ra foo    # j = foo(j);
add a0 s0 a0   # int a = i + j;
```

Epilogue:

```
lw ra 0(sp)   # Epilogue
lw s0 4(sp)   # Epilogue
addi sp sp 8   # Epilogue
jr ra         # return a;
```

main:

```
li a0 3        # int j = foo(3);
jal ra foo     # call foo
mv s0 a0       # mv rd rs1 sets rd = rs1
li a0 100      # int k = foo(100);
jal ra foo     # call foo
mv s1 a0       # Saves return value in s1
add a0 s0 s1   # int m = j+k;
```